UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2021

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time : 2 hours **(Exam date : 04.11.2021)** **Maximum Number : 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

Pre-Historic Period

1. Which one of the following ancient towns is well-known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs?

(a) Dholavira (b) Kalibangan
(c) Rakhigarhi (d) Ropar

Ans. (a): Dholavira is the ancient town, is well known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs.
Dholavira is located on Khadirbet Island in the Rann of Kachchh in Gujarat.
Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

2. Consider the following pairs:

(Historical place)		(Well-known for)
1. Burzahom	:	Rock-cut shrines
2. Chandra-ketugarh	:	Terracotta art
3. Ganeshwar	:	Copper artefacts

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

Ans. (d): Chandraketugarh: Major findings of this site include Buddhist stupas and images, decorative designs belonging to the Pala period, coins of the Gupta and Kushana period, different kinds of beads, terracotta seals, bricks and plaques depicting scenes from Jataka tales and figurines of Sunga, Maurya, Kushana and Gupta periods. Hence, pair 2 is correctly matched.
Ganeshwar: Copper artefacts, objects, microliths and pottery were found throughout the deposits. Copper objects included arrowheads, spearheads, fish hooks, bangles and chisels. Hence, pair 3 is correctly matched.
Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Gupta & Post Gupta Period

3. From the decline of Guptas unitl the rise of Harshavardhana in the early seventh century, which of the following kingdoms were holding power in Northern India?

1. The Guptas of Magadha
2. The Paramaras of Malwa
3. The Pushyabhutis of Thanesar
4. The Maukharis of Kannauj
5. The Yadavas of Devagiri
6. The Maitrakas of Valabhi

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1, 2 and 5 (b) 1, 3, 4 and 6
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 5 and 6

Ans. (b): The Guptas of Magadha, The Pushyabhutis of Thanesar, the Maukharis of Kannauj, and the Maitrakas of Valabhi, were holding power from the decline of Guptas unitl the rise of Harshavardhana in the early seventh century. Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

Buddhism & Jainism Religion

4. With reference to the history of ancient India, Bhavabhuti, Hastimalla and Kshemeshvara were famous

(a) Jain monks (b) Playwrights
(c) Temple (d) Philosophers

Ans. (b): Bhavabhuti was a famous Sanskrit playwright who wrote famous plays like Mahaviracharita, Malatimadhava etc. He is believed to be the court poet of King Yashovarman of Kannauj. Other two were also playwrights in the ancient period.
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

5. According to Portuguese writer Nuniz, the women in Vijayanagara Empire were expert in which of the following areas?

1. Wrestling 2. Astrology
3. Accounting 4. Soothsaying

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (d): Fernao Nuniz, Portuguese traveler visited the empire during the reign of Achyuta Deva Raya. According to Nuniz a large number of women were employed in royal places as dancers, domestic servants and palanquin bearers. There were also wrestlers, astrologers and soothsayers among them. Some women were also appointed as accountants, Judges, bailiffs, and watch women.
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

6. Consider the following statements:

1. It was during the reign of Iltutmish that Chengiz Khan reached the Indus in pursuit of the fugitive Khwarezm prince.
2. It was during the reign of Muhammad bin Tughluq that Taimur occupied Multan and crossed the Indus.
3. It was during the reign of Deva Raya II of Vijayanagara Empire that Vasco da Gama reached the coast of Kerala.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

Ans. (a): Statement – 1 (Correct) – Khwarizm ruler Jalaluddin who was being pursued by Chengiz Khan fled to Delhi. Sultanate Iltutmish, who was ruling Delhi then, refused the request of Jalaluddin for asylum.
Statement – 2 (Not correct) – Muhammad Tughluq died in 1351 and Timur had started his career of conquest in 1370. He crossed Indus during the reign of Firoz Shah Tughluq.
Statement – 3 (not correct) – Deva Raya – II died in 1446 and Vasco Da Gama arrived in 1498 at Calicut.
Hence, Option (a) is the correct answer.

7. With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

(a) Paragana—Sarkar—Suba
(b) Sarkar—Paragana—Suba
(c) Suba—Sarkar—Paragana
(d) Paragana—Suba—Sarkar

Ans. (a): The entire Suba was divided into Sarkars (districts), each being looked after by a military officer called the chief Shiqdar. Each Sarkar, was divided into smaller units called Parganas. There was a Shiqdar (military officer), Amin or Munsif (Civilian Judge), one Fotahdar (treasurer) and two Karkuns (clerks or writers) in each Pargana.
Hence option (a) is the correct answer.

8. With reference to Indian history, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Nizamat of Arcot emerged out of Hyderabad State.
2. The Mysore Kingdom emerged out of Vijayanagara Empire.
3. Rohilkhand Kingdom was formed out of the territories occupied by Ahmad Shah Durrani.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 only

Ans. (a): The Nizamat of Arcot was a dependency of Hyderabad and was under the legal purview of the Nizam of Hyderabad, until its demise. Later it emerged out of Hyderabad. Hence statement 1 is correct.
Mysore kingdom emerged as a powerful state under the Wodeyar dynasty, which initially served as a vassal of Vijaynagar empire. Statement 2 is also correct.
Rohilkhand state arose in the modern districts of Rampur, Bareilly etc. under the declining Mughal empire in 1721. Ahmad Shah Durrani started invading India from 1748. Hence option C is wrong.

MODERN HISTORY

9. In the first quarter of seventeenth century, in which of the following was/were the factory/factories of the English East India Company located?

1. Broach
2. Chicacole
3. Trichinopoly

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : By 1st quarter of 17th century , English East India Company had established factories at **Surat, Broach, Ahmedabad, Agra,** and **Masulipatam and not at Chicacole and Tichonopoly.**
Hence, Option (a) is the correct answer.

10. With reference to Madanapalle of Andhra Pradesh, which one of the following statements is correct?

(a) Pingali Venkayya designed the tricolour Indian National Flag here.
(b) Pattabhi Sitaramaiah led the Quit India Movement of Andhra region from here.
(c) Rabindranath Tagore translated the National Anthem from Bengali to English here.
(d) Madame Blavatsky and Colonel Olcott set up headquarters of Theosophical Society first here.

Ans. (c): The original song 'Jana Gana Mana' (National Anthem) was written in Bengali, but in a Sanskritized dialect known as Sadhu Bhasha. The idea of translating the song from Bengali to English came to Rabindranath Tagore while he was visiting the Besant Theosophical College on the invitation of Irish poet James H. Cousins. He penned down the English translation during his stay at Madanapalle, a small town in the Chittoor district of Andhra Pradesh.
Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

11. Consider the following statements:

1. The Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919 recommended granting voting rights to all the women above the age of 21.
2. The Government of India Act of 1935 gave women reserved seats in legislature.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): In line with the government policy contained in Montagu's statement of August 1917, the government announced further constitutional reforms in July 1918, known as Montagu-Chelmsford reforms; Based on these, the Government of India Act, 1919 was enacted. Under the Act, Women were given the right to vote. But there was no universal adult suffrage. Hence statement 1 is not correct.